title: "Lone Working Policy" version: "1.0" effectiveDate: "[Insert Date]" reviewDate: "[Insert Date – usually annually]" appliesTo: "All employees, agency staff, and volunteers at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]"

Lone Working Policy

Policy Title: Lone Working
Effective Date: [Insert Date]
Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]
Version: 1.0
Applies to: All employees, agency staff, and volunteers at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to protecting the health, safety, and wellbeing of all staff who may be required to work alone. Lone working can increase risks, and this policy provides clear guidance on how risks will be assessed, managed, and reduced.

We aim to:

- Ensure compliance with the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974, the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999, and the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014.
- Identify situations where lone working may occur.
- Put in place control measures to protect staff and residents.
- Promote a culture of safety, risk awareness, and clear communication.

2. Purpose

This policy sets out the arrangements for:

- Identifying lone working situations.
- Assessing risks associated with lone working.
- Implementing protective measures.
- Supporting staff wellbeing and security when working alone.

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All staff, agency workers, and volunteers who may work alone within the home, on visits outside, or in community settings.
- Situations inside the care home (e.g., night shifts, working in isolated areas).

- Situations outside the care home (e.g., escorting residents to appointments, home visits, emergency callouts).

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures lone working risk assessments are carried out and reviewed.
- Provides staff with appropriate training and resources.
- Monitors compliance and investigates incidents relating to lone working.

Supervisors / Team Leaders:

- Allocate tasks with consideration of lone working risks.
- Ensure staff follow lone working procedures.
- Act as points of contact for lone workers.

All Staff:

- Follow lone working procedures and training.
- Report hazards, risks, or incidents immediately.
- Maintain regular communication when working alone.

5. Lone Working Situations

Examples of lone working may include (but are not limited to):

- Night shifts with reduced staffing levels.
- Staff working in residents' rooms or isolated areas without immediate support.
- Escorting residents to external appointments.
- Community visits or home-based care delivery.
- Contractors or maintenance staff working alone on-site.

6. Risk Assessment and Control Measures

- Risk Assessments must be completed for all lone working tasks.
- Control measures may include:
    - Personal safety training.
    - Clear communication protocols (e.g., regular check-ins).
    - Access to panic alarms or mobile phones.
    - Restrictions on certain high-risk activities when alone.
    - Resident care risk assessments will identify if a resident poses a risk to staff working alone.

7. Communication and Monitoring

- Staff must inform their manager or designated contact when starting and completing lone working tasks.
- Regular check-ins must be agreed for community visits or extended lone working shifts.
- Emergency contact procedures must be in place, including access to on-call managers.

8. Incident Reporting

- Any incidents, accidents, or near misses involving lone working must be reported immediately.

- Incident reports will be reviewed to update risk assessments and improve safety measures.
- Staff will be supported after any lone working incident that causes distress or harm.

9. Training

- All staff will receive training on:
    - Lone working risks and procedures.
    - De-escalation and personal safety techniques.
    - Emergency communication and reporting protocols.
- Refresher training will be provided annually or as required.

10. Monitoring and Review

- Lone working practices will be regularly audited.
- Staff feedback will be considered when updating risk assessments.
- Policy reviewed annually or sooner following incidents, regulatory changes, or new risks.

11. References

- Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974
- Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 12 (Safe Care and Treatment)
- HSE Guidance on Lone Working

12. Related Policies

- Risk Assessment Policy
- Health & Safety Policy
- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Business Continuity & Emergency Planning Policy
- Incident Reporting Policy

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